



GASTROENTEROLOGY CONSULTANTS, P.C.

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317-848-6900

You are scheduled for a colonoscopy on _____, _____ 202__ .
Report to outpatient registration at _____ a.m./p.m. at

- ☐ Carmel Endoscopy Center at 13421 Old Meridian St, Phone 317-706-1600
- ☐ St Vincent Carmel Hospital at 13500 Old Meridian St, Phone 317-582-7450
- ☐ St Vincent Fishers Hospital at 13861 Olivo Rd, entrance #3, check in 1st floor imaging dept. Phone 317-415-9077

You need to be accompanied by a driver for this exam. (A taxi cab or bus is **not** acceptable.)

YOU WILL NEED TO PURCHASE:

MiraLAX® 8.3 oz (238 g) container (No Rx required) Mix with Gatorade day before prep and refrigerate
Dulcolax® (bisacodyl) (2 tablets) (No Rx required) – You may delete if you have intolerance/diarrhea
Gatorade® (64 oz bottle) (No red or purple) – Additional Gatorade may be drunk for rehydration
Simethicone (Gas-X, Phazyme) tablets 80 mg or 125 mg (Over-the-counter) – need 80 mg - 125 mg total

MEDICATION RESTRICTIONS

You may continue to take regular medications on day before procedure except medication that would prevent your colon from being cleaned out. Example: Anti-diarrheal medications, fiber supplements.

Heart or blood pressure medications: Take these on the morning of the colon exam.

Diabetics: Take half of your evening dose of **insulin** on the day before the procedure but do not take oral diabetes medication or insulin on the day of the colonoscopy until completed. (If any questions, please contact the doctor that prescribes your insulin.)

Avoid GLP-1 drugs: weekly injectables - Trulicity, Bydureon, semaglutide (Ozempic, Wegovy) and Mounjaro for > 1 week
and GLP-1 agents taken daily – Adlyxin, Byetta, Foundayo, Rybelsus, Saxenda, Victoza and oral Wegovy one day before procedure. SGLT2 Inhibitors: Jardiance, Invokana, or Farxiga stop for 3 days.

Iron supplements (Ferrous sulfate): Stop 3 days before colonoscopy.

Blood thinner: Please discontinue **Xarelto (rivaroxaban), Eliquis (apixaban)** 1 day before colonoscopy, **Coumadin, Jantoven (warfarin), Lovenox (heparin), Arixtra (fondaparinux), Brillinta (ticagrelor), Aspirin (>81 mg) 3 days before colonoscopy** and **Plavix (clopidogrel), Effient (prasugrel), Pradaxa (dabigatran), Persantine (dipyridamole), Pletal (cilostazol), Ticlid (ticlopidine) 5 days before the colonoscopy.** Discuss with your prescribing physician for their approval before you stop any medicine that affects blood clotting.

COLON PREP INSTRUCTIONS – The Day Before Your Test

1. **Clear Liquid Diet** (see list below) beginning at breakfast. **No solid food allowed.**
2. **2:00 p.m. or immediately after work** Take 2 **Dulcolax** tablets by mouth. Patients with diarrhea or working at this time may delete this step. Patients with constipation need to include.

(Helpful hint: Topical A&D ointment or Vaseline can reduce anal irritation from the resulting diarrhea)

3. **1-2 hours later** Begin drinking half of **MiraLAX-Gatorade solution** - 8 oz. every 10-20 minutes until finished. Drink each glass quickly instead of slowly sipping. Should try to complete in 2 hours. Slow down if you develop nausea or vomiting.

Morning of your colonoscopy 3-4 hours before leaving home (You may need to set an alarm!)

4. **Early morning:** Repeat step 3 by drinking remainder of **MiraLAX-Gatorade solution** and take **Simethicone tablet**. Hint: Additional 64 oz. Gatorade is best to replenish electrolytes lost in diarrhea.

DO NOT drink anything else after this up to 1 hour before your arrival time.

Remember: Two hours of nothing by mouth is required by anesthesia before the procedure can start.

CLEAR LIQUID DIET **(No red or purple artificial colors)**

Jell-O® or gelatin (plain without fruit), coffee or tea, low-salt bouillon/broth, juices without pulp, popsicles, soda-pop, Crystal Light®, Kool-aid®, Gatorade® & hard candy. No milk products after lunch or fruit fiber.

FINAL INSTRUCTIONS

- Bring current medication list with dosages, forms from our office filled out, a picture ID and insurance cards.

Please note: There is a \$75.00 fee for procedures cancelled less than 48 hours (2 business days) before scheduled appointment time

Frequently Asked Questions about Colonoscopy

What is a colonoscopy?

Colonoscopy is a procedure that allows your physician to examine the lining of the rectum and colon for signs of cancer, polyps, or other abnormalities. A flexible tube, about the thickness of an index finger is gently inserted into the anus and advanced through the length of the entire colon. This instrument called a “colonoscope” is equipped with a tiny video camera which sends pictures to a TV screen.

What preparation is required?

The rectum and colon must be completely emptied of stool for the procedure to be effectively performed. When scheduling for the procedure, our office will supply you with information regarding your prep and dietary restrictions. You will also be sedated for the procedure, so you will need to arrange to have someone drive you home afterwards. The sedation could impair your judgment and reflexes for the rest of the day, so you should not drive or operate machinery until the next day.

Why is colonoscopy performed?

Colonoscopy is usually done as either part of a routine screening for cancer, in patients with known polyps or previous polyp removal, to evaluate a change in bowel habits or bleeding, or to evaluate inflammation in the lining of the colon. Colon cancer has become a leading cause of cancer deaths in the country, killing over 55,000 people each year, more than breast and pancreatic cancer combined. The good news is that it is also one of the most preventable types of cancer. This is because the majority of colon cancers begin as a small noncancerous growth called a polyp. Polyps grow slowly and can eventually turn into cancer. This transformation can take as long as ten years, during which time you feel perfectly fine, showing no symptoms.

Who should be screened?

Colon cancer affects all races, men and women about equally. Current guidelines suggest screening for all average risk adults over the age of 45. If the exam is normal and there are no other risk factors, repeat examinations should be performed at ten year intervals.

High risk individuals are screened more often. These would include those with symptoms, prior colon cancer or polyps, inflammatory bowel disease, and those with a family history of colon cancer or polyps.

Will my insurance cover a screening colonoscopy?

Since screening colonoscopy is considered routine care, the answer will depend on the insurance plan. Medicare recipients over the age of 45 are now covered for average risk screenings if they have not had a previous colonoscopy within the past ten years. The Medicare Part B deductible is waived in these cases.

CMS now requires all insurance companies to cover colonoscopy starting at age 45 for screening. You will need to contact your benefits representative for information specific to your plan.

Will my benefits for routine procedures apply if a polyp is discovered during the course of a screening colonoscopy?

If a polyp or other abnormality is found during a screening colonoscopy, a few insurance companies may not consider the procedure to be a routine screening but instead cover the service as a diagnostic procedure. Government and private insurance companies allow for a billing code which specifies that the procedure should be handled as a screening procedure and not as a diagnostic procedure even when a polyp is removed. You should contact your insurance company if you have any questions regarding how your benefits will apply in this specific situation.